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From: Chris at Flock Safety
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To: jbabkiewicz@townofbluffton.com
Subject: Update on Federal Law Enforcement Collaboration and Local Control
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Flock Safety

Dear Chief Babkiewicz,

We are writing to share an important update regarding Flock Safety's work with federal law enforcement agencies, a necessary extension of our mission to help communities stay safe while earning and keeping public trust.

We understand that you face a daily reality where violent offenders do not respect jurisdictional boundaries. Recent high-stakes incidents underscore that in cases involving active fugitives, missing persons, or serious violent crime, coordination across city, county, and state lines is critical, and time is of the essence.

We have published a detailed blog post (which you can read here) that explains the principles guiding our work with federal agencies.

If you do not currently share with federal agencies, the default setting is that you are undiscoverable to any federal agencies. If you would like to change that, you must proactively log into Flock and adjust your settings.

Please be aware that clients who are currently sharing with federal law enforcement agencies, or who enable federal sharing in response to this message, may receive a data sharing request from the FBI in the coming days. If you receive one, please review and approve or deny the request at your earliest convenience. You can reach out to me with any questions.

Below are the key takeaways from this update:

Our Mission Remains the Same: Safety and Civil Liberties

From day one, Flock was designed to balance public safety needs with civil liberties. This principle guides our entire system:

- **Purpose-Built:** Focused on public safety, not generalized monitoring.
- **Local Ownership:** Data is owned and controlled exclusively by local agencies, not a centralized database.
- **Accountability:** Built-in audit logs, access controls, and default limited data retention ensure transparency and responsible use.

Principled Collaboration with Federal Law Enforcement
To address how crime moves faster than jurisdictions, while acknowledging the reality of state and local sharing restrictions, we are reiterating our compliance features, built on the same foundation of transparency and accountability we've committed to you.

We never compromise on local control:

Principle	Detail
Local Control Reigns Supreme	Flock data belongs solely to the agency that owns the cameras. There is **no backdoor** access. Any sharing must be explicitly **permission-based and opt-in** by the local agency.
Default: Undiscoverable	**Our default setting is to make ALL local police agencies undiscoverable** by federal law enforcement within the Flock system.
The "Three Gates" for Sharing	For a local agency to establish a sharing relationship with federal law enforcement, three steps must be taken: 1. Local agency explicitly allows federal law enforcement to **discover** their presence (Off by default). 2. Federal law enforcement must then **request access**. 3. The local agency must then **accept** the request.

	*Note: This process is specifically for initiating new data-sharing relationships with federal agencies. It does not alter or supersede any existing data-sharing agreements you already have with federal agencies. Customers who already have a federal sharing relationship in place are **not** affected by the 'default off' setting.*
Legitimate Public-Safety Use	Use is strictly tied to legitimate public-safety objectives (serious crimes, active threats, etc.). Every search is logged with an associated NIBRS-based offense type.

This principled integration is the responsible path forward. It ensures that essential tools are available when coordination saves lives, while maintaining the strictest guardrails and upholding your full control over your data.

We remain committed to our guiding principles: Safety with limits, human judgment always, auditable by design, transparency earns trust, and **Local control, without qualification or condition.** We encourage you to read the full blog post for a deeper understanding of our commitments. Thank you for your partnership in keeping our communities safe.

Sincerely,
Chris Colwell
SVP, Customer Experience

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